

26STCV12149 26STCV12149

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 507

Hearing date: 2026-07-16

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Case Number: 26STCV12149 Hearing Date: July 16, 2026 Dept: 507

Tentative

Ruling

Judge Nicholas

F. Daum, Department 507

HEARING

DATE: July 16, 2026 TRIAL DATE: March 28, 2028

CASE: John ZGLD Roe, et al. v. Los Angeles

Unified School District, et al.

CASE

NO.: 26STCV12149

MOTION TO SEAL AND PROCEED UNDER

PSEUDONYM

MOVING

PARTY: Plaintiffs John ZGLD Roe, et al (11

Plaintiffs)

RESPONDING

PARTY(S): No

response on eCourt as of 07/13/26

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiffs

move to proceed under pseudonyms and to seal the application for fictitious names. The motion is denied without prejudice. Plaintiffs may re-submit a motion that identifies the relevant factors in support of their motion under current law.

Generally

speaking, the public has a right to know the identity of litigants to a civil action. Plaintiffs may proceed under a pseudonym only if they meet the exacting standards that generally apply for sealing court records. (Department of Fair Employment & Housing v. Superior Court (2022) 82 Cal.App.5th 105, 111; Cal. Rules of Court, Rule 2.550(d).)

The law

governing pseudonyms has recently been clarified in *Roe v. Smith* (2025) 116 Cal.App.5th 227, 245-46. In that case, the Court of Appeal identified a variety of factors that trial courts should consider in determining whether to allow a civil plaintiff to conceal the plaintiff's identity by means of a pseudonym. Those factors include, inter alia, the risk of physical or mental harm, as opposed to reputational harm, that would be incurred by disclosure of a party's identity; the age of the parties requesting pseudonyms; whether the action is against a government entity; and whether disclosure would discourage similarly situated litigants from bringing cases. (*Roe*, supra, 116 Cal.App.5th at 245-46.)

Here,

Plaintiffs do not address *Roe* in their motion. Their papers include no evidence from which the Court could evaluate any of the *Roe* factors. The Court therefore denies the motion without prejudice.

The

Court emphasizes that, given the nature of the case and the apparent interests at stake, this denial is without prejudice.

Plaintiffs will have the opportunity, if they choose to do so, to resubmit their motion and identify the *Roe* factors at issue. If they identify the relevant *Roe* factors that demonstrate an overriding interest in pseudonymity, the Court may allow them to proceed under a pseudonym.

Thus,

Plaintiffs' Motion to Seal and Proceed Under Pseudonym is DENIED without

prejudice.

Moving Parties to give notice.

IT IS

SO ORDERED.

Dated: July 16, 2026 _____

Nicholas

F. Daum

Judge

of the Superior Court

Any party may submit on the

tentative ruling by contacting the courtroom via email at by no later than 4:00 p.m. the day before the hearing. All

interested parties must be copied on the email. It should be noted that if you submit on a tentative ruling the court will still conduct a hearing if any party appears. By submitting on the tentative you have, in essence, waived your right to be present at the hearing, and you should be aware that the court may not adopt the tentative, and may issue an order which modifies the tentative ruling in whole or in part.